THE HABIT OF CHEERFULNESS

There are scarcely any moments that won't benefit from a humorous remark or a cheerful lift. Yet still, some people regularly complain about everything, griping at the taxes and the political opposition and lambasting everyone around them. Frequently the gripers wind up in the doctor's office. But I know many executives who carry on under tremendous pressure as affably and kindly as a girl skipping down the street. They are the people who get along and stay out of the hospitals. It is particularly important in family life to develop the habit of pleasant conversation. Do not - for either your own, your children's, or your digestion's sake - make the family meal a recitation of troubles, anxieties, fears, warnings, and accusations. And what is more important, don't let the feeling pervade your family that everyone is so taken for granted that a pleasantry or kind word is unnecessary. The crabbed note that clangs daily in so many families is a good foundation for many of the neurotic characteristics of later life.

EXERCISE 1: Find words or phrases in the passage which mean the same as:

	COLUMN A	**COLUMN B**
a)	receive good (from)	
b)	amusing; funny	
c)	comment; something that is said (often casually)	
d)	complain; moan	
e)	scold violently	
f)	finish; end up *(phrase)*	
g)	person holding a high level position in a company	
h)	very great	
i)	pleasantly; politely; in a way that makes someone easy to talk to	
j)	method of walking by jumping lightly and quickly from one foot to the other	
k)	especially	
l)	in order to help someone; for the good of someone	
m)	saying a list of things aloud	
n)	statement that someone has done wrong or is to be blamed	
o)	spread through every part	
p)	benefit from without showing any appreciation *(phrase)*	
q)	bad-tempered; easily irritated	
r)	make a loud, deep, ringing noise	
s)	starting-point from which something is built or develops; basis	

EXERCISE 2: Choose the correct answer according to the passage.

1. The writer states by giving an example that, even under great pressure, ...

A) many executives show no more sense than a young girl
B) a lot of people refuse to be admitted to hospital
C) the government will not do anything to change taxes
D) there are people who manage to remain pleasant
E) some people are not even interested in the activities of their own families

2. We can infer from the writer's statement that . . . . . .

A) he himself is *very* cheerful and has an excellent sense of humour
B) families with an unpleasant atmosphere are not uncommon
C) to avoid indigestion it is best to eat one's meals in silence
D) neurotic characteristics are never apparent in the young
E) in a close family relationship, kind words are not necessary

3. The writer states that many people who habitually complain too much . . . . . .

A) pay more taxes than everyone else
B) are taken for granted by their families
C) eventually make themselves ill
D) are rarely under any pressure
E) are members of opposition parties

EXERCISE 3: Complete the sentences by selecting words from Column B in EXERCISE 1,

1. The opening of the new gallery attracted……interest from both the art world and the general public.
2. A marriage cannot survive without a……of mutual trust and respect.
3. The discontent among a small group of workers……the entire company and left an atmosphere of insecurity.
4. Perhaps if you were to send her some flowers occasionally, instead of just……her ……, she wouldn't be so irritable.
5. I thought the play was quite……, but no one else in the theatre appeared to be laughing.